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The thing about this business . . . you meet such interesting people!

LIKE DANDY ANDY COHEN who can grin at a Phil Page question, "How's it going?", answer, "You don't want to hear about my troubles, you've got some of your own," then launch a doleful tale of the way his crowd "Just threw that last one in Atlanta away."

And Joe Erautt, "Sparkling Joe" they called him when he was a Baron in 1947, which is more years ago than it ought to be. . . . Joe's here with Cohen's New Orleans Pelicans.

He paused Friday night in the midst of a right glad reunion with Eddie Glennon to be worried about words attributed to him during the Pels' Atlanta visit. . . . "Man, no," he explodes, "I never did say I disliked Paul Richards.

"Whatever would I go saying something like that for? I don't dislike anybody in baseball. It's been good to me, and the people in it.

"I did say this about Richards over there, 'He either makes you hate the game or love it.' He'll work, and he'll work you. And he's a hard man to play ball for. He demands a lot. But that doesn't mean I dislike him, or his managing. Heck, no!"

It's good-bye, for sure, to Johnny Dee, the intense young man who made four Alabama Winters far more exciting things than they ever could have been without him.